Sangam Tutorials
BY MAMTA PURSWANI

ADVANCED ENGLISH GRAMMAR

Book 3

for English Language Learners

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1 The Sentence

We need words to express our thoughts to others. Words have to be put in a certain order so that they may make sense. Such a group of words is called a sentence.

Read the following groups of words.

a. very exciting was it a match

This group of words does not make any sense.

b. in the kitchen

The group of words given makes sense but not complete sense.

c. The boy has done his homework.

This group of words makes complete sense. It is a sentence.

Every sentence

- begins with a capital letter.
- ends with either a full stop (.), a question mark (?), or an exclamation mark (!).
- has a verb.
- has a subject and a predicate.

Kinds of Sentences

There are five kinds of sentences.

1. Declarative or assertive sentence
2. Interrogative sentences
3. Imperative sentence
4. Exclamatory sentence
5. Optative sentence

Declarative or Assertive Sentence (Statement)

A sentence that makes a statement or an assertion is called a declarative or an assertive sentence. A sentence of this kind can either be affirmative or negative.

Read the sentences given below.

Humpty Dumpty sat on a wall. (Affirmative)

Prevention is better than cure. (Affirmative)

He does not want to play football. (Negative)

She does not listen to my advice. (Negative)

We put a full stop (.) at the end of an assertive sentence.

Interrogative Sentence (Question)

A sentence that asks a question is called an interrogative sentence.

Read the sentences given below.

Who is your father? What are you doing?

Do you like coffee? Will you attend the class?

We put a mark of interrogation (?) at the end of an interrogative sentence.

Imperative Sentence (Command)

A sentence that expresses a request, an order (or command), advice, or instruction is called an imperative sentence.

Read the sentences given below.

Sit down. (order)

Please tell me the way to the school. (request)

Work hard to pass. (instruction)

Do your homework properly. (order)

An imperative sentence also ends with a full stop (.).

Exclamatory Sentence

A sentence that expresses a strong or sudden feeling such as surprise, joy, anger, etc., is called an exclamatory sentence.

Read the sentences given below.

Hurrah! We have won the match. (joy)

Alas! He is no more. (grief)

How intelligent the boy is! (surprise)

What a beautiful picture! (wonder)

We put a mark of exclamation (!) at the end of an exclamatory sentence.

Optative Sentence

A sentence that expresses a wish or prayer is called an optative sentence.

Read the sentences given below.

May you live long! May God help you!

An optative sentence also ends with an exclamatory mark (!).

Parts of a Sentence

A sentence can be divided into two parts, namely a subject and a predicate.

The part which names the person or thing we are speaking about is called the subject of the sentence.

The part which tells something about that subject is called the predicate of the sentence.

Read these sentences.

	Subject	Predicate
1.	Raghav	runs fast.
2.	They	passed the examination.
3.	India	won the match.

In each of these sentences, the subject is a noun or pronoun and the predicate is a verb. Also, the subject consists of a single word.

However, the subject–part may consist of several words and so can the predicate part.

Now, read these sentences.

	Subject	Predicate
1.	My father	gave me a watch.
2.	His elder son	is lazy.
3.	A black cat	entered the kitchen.

Finding the Subject of a Sentence in a Statement

We can easily find the subject of a sentence by taking the verb and asking the question –

Finding the Subject of a Sentence in a Statement

We can easily find the subject of a sentence by taking the verb and asking the question – Who? or What?

1. Children like playing. [Who likes playing? The answer is children. So, children is the subject.]
2. The storm hit the town badly. [What hit the town badly? The answer is the storm. So, the storm is the subject.]

Subject in Interrogative and Exclamatory Sentences

In questions and exclamations, the word order is slightly changed, and the subject is not placed first. So in order to find out the subject, we ask ourselves the following question:–

What is this sentence about? The answer names the subject.

It is also helpful to write these sentences as statements. For example,

(a) Has he eaten the meal? (Question)

In order to find the subject, we may write this sentence as –

(a) He has eaten the meal. (Statement)

Now, we can easily see that the subject is he.

(b) How foolish you are! (Exclamation)

We may write this sentence as –

(b) You are (how) foolish. [The subject is you.]

Sometimes the subject is not mentioned but understood. For example,

Keep quiet. You keep quiet.

Subject

Objects and Components

An object in a sentence is a person or a thing that is influenced by the action of the verb in the sentence. An object is a noun or a pronoun and comes after the verb. The object in an active voice sentence can be turned into subject of a sentence in the passive voice.

Read the sentences given below.

1. Rohan opens the book.
2. Ankit cuddled the dog.

Here, the book and the dog are objects.

A complement is generally a noun or an adjective. It comes after verbs, like is, am, are, was, were, has, have, seen, appear, become, look, etc. It expresses the quantity, the state or the identity of the subject or the object. Without a complement a sentence remains incomplete. The complement cannot become the subject of a passive voice sentence.

1. He is a *cheat*.
2. She looks *happy*.
3. They are *lazy*.

In the above sentences, the words in italics are complements. They express the quality or identity or condition of the subjects. Without them the sentences are incomplete.

In the same way, a complement may also express the quality or identity of an object.

1. Ankita made me *angry*.
2. They called him a *fool*.

The words 'angry' and 'fool' are the complements of the objects 'me' and 'him'. Without these words the sentences are incomplete.

EXERCISE

A. Rearrange the words to make meaningful sentences.

1. grew tree house the behind banyan the

_____

2. branches enormous ground the to its hung

_____

3. the dog the naughty boy kicked

_____

4. anything forgets Rohan never

_____

5. went to the planetarium yesterday Pooja

_____

6. marvellous I seen had such never tree a

_____

B. Mention the kind of each sentence.

1. Would you please lend me your pen? _____
2. I asked him how old he was. _____
3. I find the task very difficult. _____
4. Is it early yet? _____
5. May you be happy and prosperous! _____
6. There are many strange animals in the zoo. _____
7. Come when you like. _____
8. It is a story without truth. _____

C. Write the following into interrogative sentences.

1. She will visit us tomorrow.

   _____.

2. They are not clever enough.

   _____.

3. All the students have done well.

   _____.

4. We should not be impatient.

   _____

D. Encircle the subject and underline the predicate in each of the following sentences.

1. The camel is the ship of the desert.
2. Wait outside the park.
3. Are you coming to the party?
4. Each of them has bought a scooty.
5. Does he like his new school?

E. Make imperative sentences (commands or requests) from the following groups of jumbled words.

1. own your mind business

   _____.

2. not a noise make do

   _____.

3. four of milk glasses us give please

   _____.

4. here please come like you whenever.

   _____

.

2 Nouns and Kinds of Nouns

A noun is the name of a person, place, animal, thing, feeling, or thought. All naming words are nouns.

Examples : Priya, boy, class, iron, truth, etc.

Kinds of Nouns

There are five kinds of nouns.

1. Proper Noun
2. Common Noun
3. Collective Noun
4. Material Noun
5. Abstract Noun

Proper Noun: A proper noun is the special name of a particular person, place, animal, or thing. It always begins with a capital letter.

Examples:

- Richa is my sister.
- The word Richa is the particular name of a person.
  So, Richa is a proper noun.

Read some examples of proper nouns.

- Chandigarh is a beautiful place.
- We live in Mumbai.
- New Delhi is the capital of India.

Chandigarh, Mumbai, New Delhi and India are the examples of proper nouns.

Common Noun: A common noun is a name given in common to every person or thing of the same class or kind.

Example:

Kapil is an honest man.

The word 'man' can be used for any man. It does not point out any particular man. It is common to all men. It is, therefore, called a common noun.

Collective Noun: A collective noun is the name of a collection of persons or things taken together and spoken of as a whole.